

FIRST AID FOR ZOMBIE SCRUM

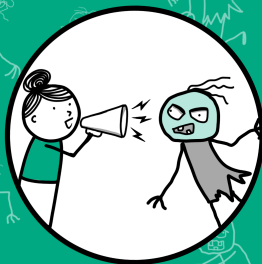


1 Take Responsibility

You haven't caused this situation, but nothing will change unless people like you step up. Don't blame or hide behind others. Model responsible behavior and investigate how you may be, inadvertently, contributing to Zombie Scrum yourself.

2 Assess the Situation

Find out as much as you can about what is going on. What problems do you see? How do they manifest? Do you have data to back up what you're saying? Why should others care? If you can't answer these questions, you will fight alone.



3 Create Awareness

Make others—both inside and outside your team—aware of what is happening. They may not have realized it yet. Create urgency and show what is lost to your team and the organization because of the problems caused by Zombie Scrum.

4 Find Other Survivors

Once you have created awareness, you will find others in your organization who have started to see the problem too. Form groups and build networks to increase your reach and strengthen your ability to recover.



5 Start Small

Instead of immediately going for the "Big Ones," start with the small and incremental changes that you have control over. Recovering from Zombie Scrum is complex work, so use short feedback cycles to quickly adapt to the situation as it unfolds.

6 Stay Positive!

Complaints, cynicism, and sarcasm don't help anyone. They may even contribute to teams sliding further into Zombie Scrum. Instead, highlight what is working well, where improvements are taking place, and what is possible when you work together. Use humor to lighten the mood, but not to sugarcoat the truth.



7 Celebrate

You won't recover from Zombie Scrum overnight. It may take a while before you start noticing improvements. This is perfectly okay. No matter how small they are, celebrate successes together when they happen, to offset the eventual setbacks you will also face.

8 Find Help

Look for help outside of your own organization. Join or start a regional Scrum Meetup. Reach out to Scrum Masters who inspire you. Or join workshops or classes with people who face similar challenges.

